

Student Instructions

Term 2 - HPWP #2 Professionalism and Interprofessionalism

In Term 2 HPWP Professionalism session, students reflect on communication and interprofessionalism to help build their professional identity and skills.

Required Pre-reading

- Interprofessional Training: Not Optional in Good Medical Education. P Burcher 2016. <http://journalofethics.ama-assn.org/2016/09/ecas2-1609.html>

Learning Objectives

Students will

1. Explain how professional communication, including the ability to summarize complex medical terminology, enhances effective patient education across health disciplines
2. Develop professional communication techniques for negotiating collaborative solutions.
3. Analyze the effectiveness of verbal and non-verbal communication skills through role playing scenarios.
4. Identify challenges to professionalism, and explore strategies for managing them, recognizing that conflicts often involve multiple perspectives and interpretations.
5. Discuss the importance of the roles played by all members of the healthcare team, including nurses, midwives and support staff in delivering effective patient care
6. Reflect on the importance of being open to diverse perspectives in creating a shared plan forward.

1. Introductions (15 mins)

Introduce yourself, then say something about *your* goal for the session (to get to know them, to make them laugh, to be a professional role model, or other that you want to accomplish)

1. Ask students to *think about* someone they admire professionally
2. Now ask them to think in their own mind what *quality they admire* in that

person. Tell them it might be a quality that they want to emulate like 'integrity', 'easy to talk to', 'always available', 'curious', 'tolerant', etc. Finally, ask each student to tell everyone their name and the quality they thought of and want to emulate (not who or why – just the quality itself in 1-5 words)

3. Reflect on your experience so far as a medical professional in training:
 - I. What progress have you made?
 - II. How would you describe your professional identity now?

2. Professional Communication – Disagreement on healthcare plan

Include as a pre-reading: <https://journalofethics.ama-assn.org/article/when-doctors-disagree/2006-09>

Have three students act out the following scenario:

Dr. Smith (in-patient team): “Esteemed colleagues, I believe that it is unethical to continue the aggressive chemotherapy for Mr. Williams, given his poor prognosis and the severe side effects he is experiencing. Our responsibility as a health-promoting organization is to prioritize his quality of life. The frequent hospitalizations and complications from the treatment are diminishing whatever time he has left. We must consider hospice care to ensure he can spend his remaining time comfortably at home.”

Dr. Lee (oncologist): “While I understand Dr. Smith’s concerns about Mr. Williams’ quality of life, it is also important to respect his and his family’s wishes. They have expressed a strong desire to continue treatment and maintain full code status. Our duty is to provide them with all the information they need to make informed decisions, but ultimately, it is up to them to decide the course of action. We can support this by continuing the current treatment plan and providing thorough education about his prognosis and options.”

Dr. Johnson (in-patient team): “Dr. Smith and Dr. Lee bring up valid points, but we must not forget that as a healthcare team, our decisions affect not only Mr. Williams but also his family and the broader community. Open and honest discussions about hospice care, focusing on comfort and support, can help the family understand the benefits of this option. We need to ensure that Mr. Williams receives the best possible care that aligns with his values and needs, while also addressing the emotional and psychological impact on his loved ones.”

The inpatient team became frustrated. Despite Mr. Williams’ prognosis of less than six months to live, the oncologists seemed unwilling to be frank in their discussions with his family, “not wanting to remove hope” and pushing for an aggressive alternative treatment strategy. This is what the family would want, they reasoned. But the inpatient team knew that the family failed to understand Mr. Williams’ prognosis and thus could not make a truly informed decision. The inpatient team confronted the oncology fellow, who became upset and defensive. “We’re not ready to give up on Mr. Williams, and neither is his family,” An impasse had been reached, and Dr. Lee stormed off, threatening to discontinue his participation in Mr. Williams’ care.

Now ask the questions below. Don't answer these yourself. There is no right or wrong answer (but may be right or wrong – professional or unprofessional – behaviors, communication, and attitudes).

1. What does this case demonstrate about professionalism and communication?
2. How can different members of the healthcare team effectively collaborate to ensure that the patient's values and wishes are respected while also providing the best possible medical advice and support?
3. How should physicians manage or resolve professional disagreements?
4. Discuss specific strategies for improving communication and resolving conflicts among team members.

3. Interprofessionalism

- 1) Recap the article on interprofessional training (Burcher 2016)?
- 2) Do you think Dr Chan should re-schedule the student as requested? Why or why not?
- 3) In this situation, do you think that you would have resented being scheduled to shadow a midwife or other member of the team?
- 4) How did this reading affect your understanding of what clinical practice involves?
- 5) What is humility, and how does it apply to the reading or our discussion about it?
- 6) How does interprofessionalism differ from professionalism?

4. Case Discussion – Social media

Students received and read the case below. Ask the group “Who can remind us what happened in the case about Social Media?” If needed, you can ask someone else “What else do we know from the case?” or paraphrase it yourself – but only if needed. Then move on to the questions below.

Priya is a 1st year medical student who has done almost nothing but study for the past three weeks. She is fairly confident that she is mastering the material. It's Friday night, and some of her friends are going out. They often stay out late partying and she wants to join them because she needs a break and a social life. She drinks more than usual and the next day has no memory of going home. When she checks social media,

someone posted suggestive pictures her dancing on a table.

1. Is there a place for professionalism in the use of social media?
2. What is professionally acceptable when utilizing social media
3. How can a medical professional strike a balance with their professional identity and socialization
4. How should Priya address the situation with her friends and the person who posted the photos?
5. What steps can she take to ensure that her personal boundaries and professional image are respected in the future?